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Culture (OWC): [San \(FX10\)](#)

Region: Africa

Sub Region: Southern Africa

Field Date: 1958-1966

Coverage Date: 1958-1966

Place Coverage: G/Wi, Ghanzi District, Botswana

Section Title(S)

Interband migration • The G/wi kinship system

Interband migration

An intermittent exchange of members occurs between bands. Whole households migrate to other bands for a variety of reasons. Many children marry into bands other than those of their birth, and divorced or widowed spouses move back into their old bands or away from unhappy situations. The gross annual rate of short-term migration is very high, exceeding 200 percent of the membership of some bands in years of good rainfall when there is plenty of food and travel is relatively easy. Determination of the rate of permanent migration, as distinct from visits of shorter than one year's duration, presented much the same difficulties as did census taking. Reliable data were gathered in only four of the six bands investigated. Between 1959 and 1966:

≠xade band: 5 households left and 3 joined

G!ō:sa band: 2 households joined

Easter Pan band: 3 households left and 2 joined

Tsxobe band: 6 households left and 6 joined

Piper Pans band: 6 households left, 2 joined (1960–1964)

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The G/wi kinship system

The G/wi kinship system is characterized by a dichotomy of kindred (excluding spouses) into joking and avoidance/relationships, a virtual absence of lineage structures or other corporate kin groups beyond the

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nuclear family, and a ready facilitation of fission and fusion within and between groups of kin. From an ego focus, its primary extent encompasses three ascending and three descending generations in the vertical dimension. Horizontally it covers parents' siblings and their spouses and two generations of their descendants and the spouses of these descendants.  143 The system is bilaterally symmetrical in that there is neither terminological nor normative discrimination between matrikin and patrikin. The scope of the system is widened beyond these categories by the institution of fictional siblinghood and the universalistic device of incorporating kin-of-kin into the network of joking and avoidance/respect relationships.

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